National Transportation Safety Board
Aviation Accident Final Report

Location:	Fallbrook, CA	**Accident Number:**	LAX08CA035
Date & Time:	12/06/2007, 1700 PST	**Registration:**	N44528
Aircraft:	Piper PA-28-180	**Aircraft Damage:**	Substantial
Defining Event:		**Injuries:**	2 None
Flight Conducted Under:	Part 91: General Aviation - Personal		

Analysis

While on approach for landing, the airplane encountered a downdraft. The pilot attempted to arrest the sink rate by applying full power; however, the airplane landed hard and short of the runway, damaging surrounding vegetation and a runway edge light. After the hard landing the pilot was able to get the airplane airborne again and he decided to return to his home base airport. During the flight back to his home airport the left wheel and strut fell from the airplane.

Probable Cause and Findings

The National Transportation Safety Board determines the probable cause(s) of this accident to be: The pilot's misjudged distance and altitude that led to an undershoot and a failure to obtain the proper touchdown point.

Findings

Occurrence #1: UNDERSHOOT
Phase of Operation: APPROACH - VFR PATTERN - FINAL APPROACH

Findings
1. WEATHER CONDITION - DOWNDRAFT
2. (C) DISTANCE/ALTITUDE - MISJUDGED - PILOT IN COMMAND
3. (C) PROPER TOUCHDOWN POINT - NOT OBTAINED - PILOT IN COMMAND

Occurrence #2: ON GROUND/WATER COLLISION WITH OBJECT
Phase of Operation: LANDING - FLARE/TOUCHDOWN

Findings
4. OBJECT - RUNWAY LIGHT
5. TERRAIN CONDITION - HIGH VEGETATION

Factual Information

Pilot Information

Certificate:	Flight Instructor; Commercial; Military	**Age:**	43, Male
Airplane Rating(s):	Multi-engine Land; Single-engine Land	**Seat Occupied:**	Left
Other Aircraft Rating(s):	None	**Restraint Used:**	Seatbelt, Shoulder harness
Instrument Rating(s):	Airplane	**Second Pilot Present:**	No
Instructor Rating(s):	Airplane Multi-engine; Airplane Single-engine	**Toxicology Performed:**	No
Medical Certification:	Class 2 Without Waivers/Limitations	**Last FAA Medical Exam:**	07/01/2007
Occupational Pilot:	Yes	**Last Flight Review or Equivalent:**	06/01/2007
Flight Time:	3428 hours (Total, all aircraft), 110 hours (Total, this make and model), 3112 hours (Pilot In Command, all aircraft), 28 hours (Last 90 days, all aircraft), 18 hours (Last 30 days, all aircraft), 2 hours (Last 24 hours, all aircraft)		

Aircraft and Owner/Operator Information

Aircraft Make:	Piper	**Registration:**	N44528
Model/Series:	PA-28-180	**Aircraft Category:**	Airplane
Year of Manufacture:		**Amateur Built:**	No
Airworthiness Certificate:	Normal	**Serial Number:**	28-7405256
Landing Gear Type:	Tricycle	**Seats:**	4
Date/Type of Last Inspection:	09/01/2007, Annual	**Certified Max Gross Wt.:**	2450 lbs
Time Since Last Inspection:	48 Hours	**Engines:**	1 Reciprocating
Airframe Total Time:	1868 Hours as of last inspection	**Engine Manufacturer:**	Lycoming
ELT:	Installed, not activated	**Engine Model/Series:**	O-360-A4A
Registered Owner:	Gary Reamer	**Rated Power:**	180 hp
Operator:	Pacific Coast Flyers	**Operating Certificate(s) Held:**	None

Meteorological Information and Flight Plan

Conditions at Accident Site:	Visual Conditions	**Condition of Light:**	Day
Observation Facility, Elevation:	CRQ, 331 ft msl	**Distance from Accident Site:**	14 Nautical Miles
Observation Time:	1545 PST	**Direction from Accident Site:**	186°
Lowest Cloud Condition:	Thin Overcast / 1900 ft agl	**Visibility**	10 Miles
Lowest Ceiling:	Broken / 3500 ft agl	**Visibility (RVR):**	
Wind Speed/Gusts:	8 knots /	**Turbulence Type Forecast/Actual:**	/
Wind Direction:	180°	**Turbulence Severity Forecast/Actual:**	/
Altimeter Setting:	30.1 inches Hg	**Temperature/Dew Point:**	18°C
Precipitation and Obscuration:	No Obscuration; No Precipitation		
Departure Point:	CARLSBAD, CA (CRQ)	**Type of Flight Plan Filed:**	None
Destination:	Fallbrook, CA	**Type of Clearance:**	None
Departure Time:	1600 PST	**Type of Airspace:**	

Airport Information

Airport:	FALLBROOK COMMUNITY AIRPARK (L18)	**Runway Surface Type:**	Asphalt
Airport Elevation:	708 ft	**Runway Surface Condition:**	Dry
Runway Used:	18	**IFR Approach:**	None
Runway Length/Width:	2160 ft / 60 ft	**VFR Approach/Landing:**	Touch and Go; Traffic Pattern

Wreckage and Impact Information

Crew Injuries:	1 None	**Aircraft Damage:**	Substantial
Passenger Injuries:	1 None	**Aircraft Fire:**	None
Ground Injuries:	N/A	**Aircraft Explosion:**	None
Total Injuries:	2 None	**Latitude, Longitude:**	33.352500, -117.250556

Administrative Information

Investigator In Charge (IIC):	Patrick H Jones	**Report Date:**	02/28/2008
Additional Participating Persons:	Steve Nelson; Federal Aviation Administration; San Diego, CA		
Publish Date:	06/17/2019		
Note:	This accident report documents the factual circumstances of this accident as described to the NTSB.		
Investigation Docket:	NTSB accident and incident dockets serve as permanent archival information for the NTSB's investigations. Dockets released prior to June 1, 2009 are publicly available from the NTSB's Record Management Division at pubinq@ntsb.gov, or at 800-877-6799. Dockets released after this date are available at http://dms.ntsb.gov/pubdms/.		

The National Transportation Safety Board (NTSB), established in 1967, is an independent federal agency mandated by Congress through the Independent Safety Board Act of 1974 to investigate transportation accidents, determine the probable causes of the accidents, issue safety recommendations, study transportation safety issues, and evaluate the safety effectiveness of government agencies involved in transportation. The NTSB makes public its actions and decisions through accident reports, safety studies, special investigation reports, safety recommendations, and statistical reviews.

The Independent Safety Board Act, as codified at 49 U.S.C. Section 1154(b), precludes the admission into evidence or use of any part of an NTSB report related to an incident or accident in a civil action for damages resulting from a matter mentioned in the report. A factual report that may be admissible under 49 U.S.C. § 1154(b) is available here.